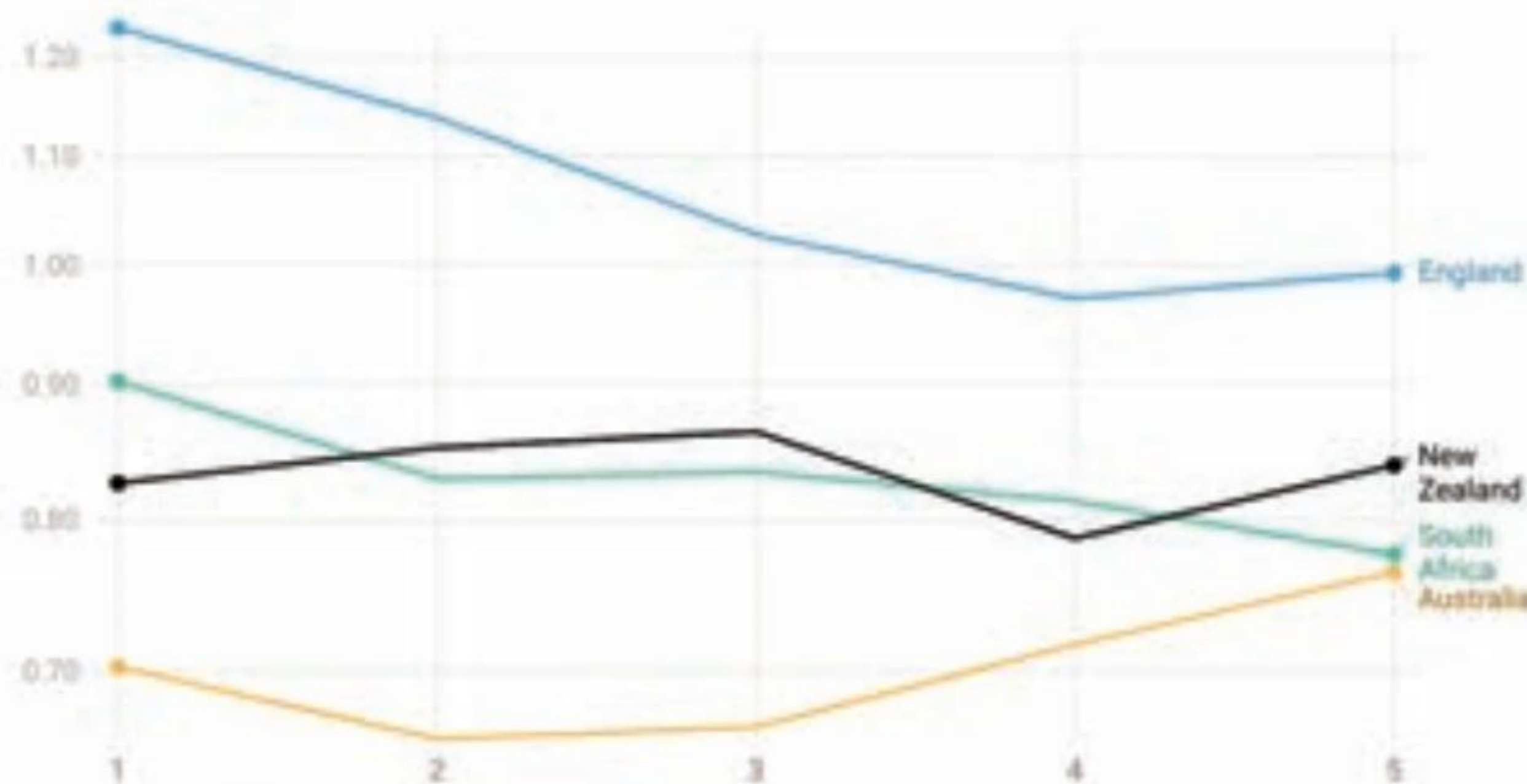




Deadly duo: One small consolation for the visitor is the absence of England's legendary swing duo — James Anderson and Stuart Broad. K.R. DEEPAK

Average swing in Test cricket in SENA countries across match days

X Axis - Test match day | Y Axis - Average swing



Based on all Test matches from 2005 with ball-tracking data (Cricviz)

question has long been a perplexing one. India's top-order batters have averaged just 30.31 in England across 121 Tests since 1932 — their second-lowest return in any country, ahead of only South Africa (28.88).

While Indian batting began to improve in England in the 1970s and peaked in the 2000s, the trend has reversed in recent times.

Since 2010, India has played 23 Tests in England — across four bilateral series and two World Test Championship finals. In these matches, its top-order average has slumped to 28.69 — only four teams have fared worse in that span. It is also India's third-lowest average in any country during this period.

Interestingly, India's struggles are